Text vs. Film Adaptation Analysis Rubric

Criteria for scene selection, lighting symbolism, theme preservation, and evidence.

English 8 | Unit 5 | Day 21

The Outsiders: Novel vs. Film

STUDENT NAME	PERIOD	DATE	SCENE / CLIP ANALYZED

CRITERIA	4 Exceeds	3 Meets	2 Approaching	1 Beginning	SCORE
Directorial Scene Selection What the film keeps, cuts, or changes	Explains in detail why scenes were kept, cut, or reordered and how this reshapes what the audience learns about characters and conflict.	Identifies key kept, cut, or changed scenes and explains the effect of the decisions on story and characters.	Names some kept or cut scenes but explains their effect only in general terms.	Lists scenes with little or no explanation of the director's reasons or the effect.	
Visual & Lighting Symbolism Light, color, camera, and sound	Connects specific lighting, color, camera angle, or sound choices to symbolic meaning and shows how they replace Hinton's written description.	Describes lighting or camera choices and explains the mood or meaning they create.	Mentions visual details but meaning is vague or only partly connected to the scene.	Describes what happens on screen without addressing lighting or symbolism.	
Theme Preservation Hinton's message across media	Judges clearly whether the theme of class division and empathy is strengthened, weakened, or preserved, supported by contrasting evidence.	States a clear judgment about theme and supports it with relevant evidence from the novel and film.	Theme is mentioned, but the judgment is unclear or supported by one medium only.	Theme is missing, inaccurate, or not connected to the adaptation.	
Evidence from Both Media Quotes, pages, timestamps	Uses accurate, well-chosen quotes with page numbers and timestamps that directly prove each point.	Includes accurate quotes and timestamps that mostly support each point.	Evidence is limited, partly inaccurate, or missing page numbers or timestamps.	Little or no evidence from the novel or film is provided.	
Organization & Written Response Clarity and conventions	Ideas flow logically with precise academic vocabulary and almost no conventions errors.	Ideas are organized and clear, with minor conventions errors that do not block meaning.	Organization is uneven and errors sometimes make the ideas hard to follow.	Ideas are disorganized or hard to understand.	

TEACHER COMMENTS

TOTAL (of 20)

18-20 Exceeds | 14-17 Meets | 9-13 Approaching | 5-8 Beginning